

Grace Stephens

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EDUCATION

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

Master of Science in Computer Science (3+1 Joint Degree)

Chicago, IL

Expected June 2027

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

Bachelor of Arts in Cognitive Science

Chicago, IL

Expected June 2027

GPA: 3.73/4.00

Systems Programming I/II, Discrete Mathematics, Biotechnology for the 21st Century, Introduction To Computer Science I/II, Calculus I/II, Philosophy of AI, Managerial Decision Making, and Foundations of Neuroscience

EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Research Assistant

Chicago

Quad Summer Undergraduate Research Scholar at Pearson Lab.

August 2026 - September 2026

- Built an end-to-end deep learning pipeline (PyTorch, DINOv2 ViT) to classify bone marrow cells, processing 1M+ cells per slide with custom region-detection algorithms and classifiers trained on 170K+ labeled cells.
- Improved model agreement with expert pathologist counts from near-zero to a strong positive correlation by validating against clinical ground truth and diagnosing/correcting a cell-sampling flaw.

AI Security Research Group Member

Chicago

XLab

April 2025 - Present

- Built working knowledge of AI safety and security threat models (misalignment, model tampering, data poisoning) by completing two quarter-long fellowships, AI Safety Fundamentals and AI Security

Machine Learning Research Fellow

Chicago

BSCD Research Fellowship in the Application of ML and AI

June 2025 - September 2025

- Trained aMIL classifiers using a ViT pipeline to analyze bone biopsy slides for features in cancer prediction.
- Developed and implemented model interpretability techniques such as mosaic mapping, magnification testing, and feature space analysis to improve transparency and clinically-relevant interpretation of model predictions.

Research Intern

Remote

Cohort Participant Digital Cell Imaging Research Experience at University of Florida

May 2025 - June 2025

- Researched bioinformatics, AI, and spatial-omics, analyzing large-scale biomedical data using HuBMAP.

Research Assistant

Chicago

SAND Lab (Security, Algorithms, Networking, and Data)

September 2024 - June 2025

- Oversaw increased access to AI privacy tools and collaborating in adversarial machine learning research.
- Built counterattack algorithms to prevent body swapping AI from operating on individuals without consent.

Software Engineering Intern

Remote

AlphaOcean

June 2024 - August 2024

- Authored a program to automate efficient shipping strategy solutions for tankers worldwide.
- Developed algorithms for shipping data analysis, informing team strategy and client-facing presentations.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

S&P Price Prediction Models - AI In Finance Program

2026

- Conducted AI news sensitivity analysis and built S&P price prediction models through trading simulations.

Intermediate Cybersecurity Projects - Codepath

2025

- Detected and mitigated cybersecurity threats through vulnerability assessments and secure coding practices.

Visual Novel Development and Tech Advocacy

2020-2022

- Spent over 120 hours learned to write, program, illustrate, and promote the entire educational game solo.
- Published game with over 550 views and 60 downloads. Earned the highest Girl Scout award, the Gold Award.

Mini-Game Development

2020-2024

- Built half a dozen or more mini games using various searching, pathfinding, and recursive algorithms.

PROFICIENCIES

Technical Skills: Experienced in Claude Code, PyTorch, Python, C, Java, Bash, Pandas, NumPy, and Git.

Certifications: Codepath's Intermediate Cybersecurity, Nvidia's Fundamentals of Deep Learning

Tools: VS Code, GitHub, Excel, Splunk, Catalyst, Wireshark, Adobe Suite, Microsoft Suite, Google Cloud Platform

Memberships: Rewriting the Code, CodePath, AnitaB, All Tech Is Human, ACM-W, Smart Women Securities

Hobbies: Learning Spanish and Chinese, reading, cooking, and trying new styles of dance